

had believed that it was a smart idea that they both worked at the same place. They only had to have one car, so they saved in commuting costs. Always responsible with their money, they even had their car paid off. Steve and Maria never anticipated that they would both suddenly be without jobs, with no notice to prepare. One day, they showed up for work and there was no company to work for. With both of them out of work, the bills piled up so quickly, it scared them. They let fear overtake them, and they worried about everything. In their panic, they wrongfully assumed that bankruptcy was the only way to get out of the financial mess that they had unexpectedly found themselves in.

The first thing that Ed and Sue told Steve and Maria to do: Lose the worry and the fear. It does nothing to help the situation. Lying awake at night or arguing with your spouse does nothing to cure the debt. The next thing they did was give them a copy of this book.

Ed and Sue were so energized by their success in making the phone calls to the credit card companies that had saved them thousands of dollars, they encouraged Steve and Maria to do the same. They told Steve and Maria to go one step further – call the credit card companies and negotiate a settlement.

Steve and Maria really were at the end of their financial rope. They were shocked to learn that negotiating a settlement directly with the credit card companies was even a possibility. They had made an appointment with a bankruptcy lawyer and were not asked any questions over the phone, just, “We’ll see you next week.” They were surprised to hear that there might be other options. The credit card companies want to get their money and do not want to resort to collections if they don’t have to. Jump the gun and beat them to the punch.

Steve called his credit card company and explained that he had not been making his payments because he and his wife had both lost their jobs, and were, in fact, meeting with a bankruptcy lawyer next week. He explained that they currently had no income and had wiped out their savings paying their house payment. Based on the *Debt Cures* advice, Steve sent in his financial statements showing his net worth, which proved that he had no ability to pay. It took a few phone calls and some letters, and Steve and Maria were able to settle their credit card fees for half of what they owed! Fifty cents on the dollar is not bad!